

Category Policy Addendum: Apparel

KARTWAY CUSTOMER OPERATIONS POLICY HANDBOOK ## ADDENDUM APP-04: APPAREL, FOOTWEAR, AND ACCESSORIES (CATEGORY 12)

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1.0 SCOPE AND APPLICABILITY This addendum establishes the specific customer service, return, refund, and warranty rules for all items listed under Category 12 (Apparel, Footwear, and Accessories) on the Kartway marketplace. This policy supersedes the General Customer Operations Policy (Ref: COP-01.4) where direct conflicts exist.

2.0 RETURN WINDOWS AND TIMELINES * 2.1 Standard Category Return

Window: Notwithstanding the standard Kartway 30-day return policy, all standard items in Category 12 (excluding subcategories defined in Clause 2.2) must be postmarked for return within 21 calendar days from the

carrier-confirmed delivery date. * 2.2 Special Subcategory Restrictions: * 2.2.1

Eveningwear & Bridal (Subcategory 12-E): All items in this subcategory must be postmarked for return within 7 calendar days of delivery. No extensions are

permitted under any circumstances. * 2.2.2 Seasonal Holiday Costumes

(Subcategory 12-C): Items purchased between October 1st and October 31st must be postmarked for return on or before November 3rd of the same calendar year to be eligible for a refund.

3.0 CATEGORY-SPECIFIC CONDITION REQUIREMENTS * 3.1 Intimate Apparel and Swimwear: Items with an adhesive hygiene strip (e.g., swimsuits, bikinis, underwear, shapewear) must be returned with the original adhesive hygiene strip completely intact, untampered with, and showing no signs of re-application. * **3.2 Footwear Sole Integrity:** Returned footwear must show zero signs of outdoor wear. The soles must be pristine. If dirt, scuffing, or gravel indentation is detected by the Kartway Apparel Quality Assurance (AQA) team, the return must be rejected, and the item shipped back to the buyer at their expense. * **3.3 Security Seals:** High-value designer apparel and formalwear (items priced at or above \$150.00) are shipped with a bright purple plastic "Kartway-Secure" 3D zip-seal loop. The item cannot be returned if this loop has been cut, broken, or re-attached using adhesive.

4.0 ORIGINAL PACKAGING AND HANGTAG MANDATES * 4.1 Hangtags and Labels: All manufacturer hangtags, price tags, and fabric care labels must remain attached to the garment in their original positions. If tags have been detached, the return is subject to the fees outlined in Clause 5.1. * **4.2 Footwear Packaging:** Footwear must be returned inside its original manufacturer branded shoe box. The branded shoe box must be placed inside a secondary shipping carton. * **4.2.1 Box Damage Penalty:** If a buyer returns footwear by taping the shipping label directly to the original branded shoe box (rather than using an outer shipping box), a flat \$9.00 packaging destruction fee will be deducted from the refund total.

5.0 RESTOCKING FEES AND DEDUCTIONS * 5.1 Missing Tag Fee: If an item is returned without its original manufacturer hangtags but is otherwise in unworn condition, a flat 12% restocking fee based on the purchase price of the item shall be applied. * **5.2 Broken Security Seal Fee:** If a designer or formalwear item (as defined in Clause 3.3) is returned with a broken, cut, or missing purple "Kartway-Secure" zip-seal loop, but the garment itself is deemed clean and undamaged by the AQA team, a mandatory 18% restocking fee shall be deducted from the final refund. * **5.3 Hygiene Strip Violation Fee:** Swimwear or undergarments returned with the hygiene strip removed, wrinkled, or partially detached—but showing no biological stains or odors—will not be refunded in full. Instead, a flat \$14.50 sanitization deduction will be assessed to cover specialized steam-cleaning and repackaging.

6.0 HAZARDOUS MATERIALS AND SMART APPAREL PROTOCOLS * 6.1 Smart Apparel Lithium Batteries: "Smart Apparel" (Subcategory 12-S), which includes garments containing integrated heating elements, LED lighting arrays, or biometric sensors powered by Lithium-Polymer (Li-Po) batteries, are subject to strict transport regulations. * 6.1.1 Battery Weight Threshold: Smart garments containing Li-Po batteries with a total lithium metal content exceeding 0.3 grams are classified as Class 9 Hazardous Goods. * 6.1.2 Shipping Restrictions: These items cannot be returned using standard USPS prepaid return shipping labels. Support agents must manually generate and issue a specialized "UPS Ground Hazardous" return label under Kartway Carrier Contract #774-APP. * 6.1.3 Damaged Batteries: If a customer reports that a smart garment's battery pack is swollen, punctured, or emitting heat, agents must instruct the customer *not* to return the item. Agents must process a 100% refund immediately and direct the customer to dispose of the battery at an authorized local e-waste facility.

7.0 WARRANTY PERIODS AND CLAIMS * 7.1 Standard Apparel Warranty:

Standard apparel items carry a 30-day limited warranty against manufacturer defects (e.g., broken zippers, split seams, missing buttons) starting from the delivery date. * 7.2 Performance Outerwear Extended Warranty: Items

categorized under "Performance Outerwear" (Subcategory 12-O), which includes seam-sealed waterproof jackets, windproof technical shells, and sub-zero rated down coats, carry an extended 120-day manufacturer-backed warranty against delamination, membrane failure, and waterproofing

degradation. * 7.2.1 Warranty Claim Verification: To initiate a claim under Clause 7.2, the customer must provide high-resolution photographs showing the failure of the seam tape or membrane. All claims under this clause must be escalated to the AQA tier-2 support queue for manual approval.